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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR/IMPROVEMENT/REAPPEARANCE EXAMINATION APRIL 2026
SECOND SEMESTER
Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC)
MG2DSCTRS100 - INDIAN LITERATURES IN ENGLISH TRANSLATION
(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Scheme of Valuation

Part A - MCQ
Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 mark

1)	A	It can help unify different linguistic and cultural backgrounds	[U] / [CO1]
2)	C	Kurukshetra war	[K] / [CO2]
3)	B	Forest spirit	[U] / [CO2]
4)	C	A true seeker	[U] / [CO2]
5)	D	Sirajuddin	[U] / [CO3]
6)	B	Write a new saga of love	[U] / [CO3]
7)	C	He fasts and prays at the temple	[K] / [CO4]
8)	C	to become his friend.	[K] / [CO4]
9)	B	Brahmins cannot eat before performing the funeral rites of Naranappa.	[K] / [CO4]
10)	C	Resigned	[U] / [CO4]

[1x10 = 10]

Part B - SHORT ANSWER
Answer any 6 questions. Each question carries 5 marks

11) **Benefits** - Serves as a unifying link across India's linguistic diversity, performing a role similar to what Sanskrit did in ancient times - Allows students and scholars to read and compare literatures from different regions (e.g., a Malayalam speaker reading Bengali works) through a common language - Enables the "discovery" of regional texts by translating them into a medium that can reach a national and global audience. **Limitations** - Created a "split sensibility" where students knew more about Western classics than their own local literary traditions - Mukherjee argued that using a secondary language can stifle "creative spontaneity," leading to imitation of Western models rather than original Indian thought - Created a "great divide" between the English-speaking elite and the majority of the population who speak bhashas (mother tongues). [U] / [CO1]

12) Nishadin's voice is highly significant as it represents the marginalized subaltern tribal community – The nishadin act as an "interrogative voice" of the ignored, low caste lives sacrificed for the sake of the royal Pandavas - challenges the dominant, patriarchal narrative of the Mahabharata. [U] / [CO2]

13) Since Dhritarashtra was born blind and Gandhari chose to remain blindfolded, Kunti served as their literal guide - led them by the hand through the treacherous, uneven terrain of the forest - took on the physical toll of a forest dweller, gathering wild roots, fruits, and water to ensure the elderly couple was fed and hydrated - Despite her own aging body, she remained the "active" member of the trio, protecting the frail couple from the dangers of the wilderness for as long as she was physically able - provided a constant presence, listening to their laments about their fallen sons while silently carrying her own secret burden regarding the death of Karna. [U] / [CO2]

14) The adopted son was the center of the speaker's life and his only source of happiness - The speaker calls him "the full moon of my blighted home," meaning the child brought light to his dark, sad life - After losing his son, the speaker no longer wants to live and longs for death [U] / [CO2]

15) In *"Open It!"* by Saadat Hasan Manto, silence shows the deep trauma the characters have gone through. Sakina's lack of response at the end reveals that her suffering is so severe that she cannot express it in words. This silence makes the message clear: the violence of events like the Partition of India leaves lasting emotional wounds that remain unspoken but deeply felt. [U] / [CO3]

16) In "The Son Complains to His Mother" by Gnanakoothan, the speaker asks his mother to continue lying because her gentle reassurances give him emotional comfort, even if they are not true. He is aware of life's difficulties, but he prefers the safety and warmth of her words over facing harsh realities directly. [U] / [CO4]

17) In "The Man Who Could Not Sleep" by Perumal Murugan, Muthu Pattar feels a deep, quiet disturbance when he sees Murugesan's success. Outwardly, he remains composed, but internally he experiences hurt and a sense of diminished importance, as a younger man has surpassed him. His pride is affected because he believes that age should naturally command respect and higher status. This reaction reflects cultural expectations where elders are seen as more accomplished and deserving of recognition. Murugesan's rise unsettles this belief, creating an inner conflict in Muthu Pattar between accepting change and holding on to traditional ideas of age, pride, and dignity. [U] / [CO4]

18) In "The Man Who Could Not Sleep" by Perumal Murugan, Murugesan is portrayed as a capable and ambitious young man who achieves success through hard work and determination. He represents a new generation that is not limited by traditional expectations of age or hierarchy. Despite his success, Murugesan remains respectful and does not openly challenge elders like Muthu Pattar, which shows his grounded nature. His character highlights change in society—where merit and effort matter more than age—making him a symbol of progress and shifting values. [U] / [CO4]

19) The cockfight scene serves as a pivotal symbol of moral degradation,raw violence and greed that lie beneath the surface of traditional bhramanical society. Just as the roosters are locked in a fight to death, Praneshacharya is trapped between two opposing truths: his lifelong ascetism and his newly awakened eroticism - Witnessing this scene heightens his sense of despair and forces him to reconsider his attempt to escape. [U] / [CO4]

[5x6 = 30]

Part C - ESSAY

Answer any 2 questions. Each question carries 15 marks

20) English provides a shared linguistic space where literatures from different Indian languages (Bhashas) can meet and be compared - It acts as the primary "target language" for translations, allowing a Tamil work to be read by a Kashmiri speaker, thereby creating a pan-Indian literary consciousness - It "liberates" regional masterpieces from their linguistic borders, elevating "local" classics to the status of "national" classics - It enables Comparative Literature within India, helping scholars identify common themes, myths, and movements (like the Bhakti movement) that exist across different Indian languages. .

[U] / [CO1]

21) Bhasa moves away from the traditional "evil" portrayal, framing Duryodhana as a tragic hero rather than a spiteful antagonist - He does not complain about Bhima's "foul play" (hitting below the belt). He accepts his broken thighs as the inevitable result of fate and the war - His interaction with his son, Durjaya, shows a tender, fatherly side. He tells his son to abandon the old hatreds, prioritizing the child's peace over his own ego. - When Ashwatthama wants to continue the slaughter of the Pandavas, Duryodhana stops him, signaling that his thirst for blood has ended. He views his death

not as a punishment, but as a warrior's transition. He dies with a vision of heaven, signifying he has achieved the status of a noble hero.

[U] / [CO2]

22) In *"Open It!"* by Saadat Hasan Manto, the psychological impact of violence is conveyed in two clear ways. First, through Sakina's numb and automatic response at the end—when she reacts to the words "open it" without awareness—it shows how deeply trauma has affected her mind, reducing her ability to think or feel normally. Second, through Sirajuddin's confused and fragile mental state, as he clings to hope and fails to fully grasp what has happened, the story shows how violence can distort reality and leave a person emotionally shattered. [U] / [CO3]

23) In "The Man Who Could Not Sleep" by Perumal Murugan, the author contrasts Muthu Pattar's past and present through memory, setting, and sensory detail. Through **memory**, Pattar recalls a time when his life felt stable and satisfying, when he was respected and secure in his place. These recollections highlight how content and confident he once was and how peacefully he slept in those days. The **setting** shifts to his present surroundings, which feel restless and unsettling, especially at night, reflecting his disturbed state of mind and inability to sleep. Finally, **sensory details**—such as the silence of the night, small sounds, and his physical discomfort—intensify his unease, making his anxiety feel immediate and real. Together, these elements clearly show the contrast between his earlier peace and his current inner turmoil. [U] / [CO4]

[15x2 = 30]